

Smartphone – Budget category

What did 2015 prove? That you don't have to break the bank to own a high-performance phone. Not anymore.



Meizu M2 Note
Price: ₹9,999



YU Yureka Plus
Price: ₹8,999



Lenovo K3 Note
Price: ₹9,499

One are the days when buying a phone from the budget category meant compromising on basic features. Today, the budget smartphone category is filled with smartphones which can handle almost any task or app you throw at them. The sub-10K smartphone segment has become the battleground for all kinds of small and big brands and the hostility is widely justified.

In this segment which is highly restrained by a budget cap of ₹10,000, most smartphones fair well in some areas and lose out in others. Here are the best performing phones you can buy in the budget rang.:

Zero1 Winner

Meizu M2 Note

Meizu M2 Note is the jack of all trades in the sub-10K budget smartphone category. Unlike most phones in the category which strive in one or two aspects, the M2 Note shines in all of them. The phone comes with a Mediatek MT6753 octa-core processor which is more than capable of handling day to day tasks and even more, if required. While it is a popular SoC in the price segment, Meizu has highly optimised it for the M2 Note. It consistently performs well with next to no lag.

It houses a 5.5-inch IGZO LCD display which is undoubtedly the best display in

the segment. Colours appear natural and the viewing angles are so good that the smartphone can be used as a benchmark. The camera is good, too, and images taken offer accurate details in almost all lighting conditions. Like all Meizu phones, there is a slight learning curve to the UI (Flyme OS) but once you pass that, the phone won't give you a reason to complain.

Second

YU Yureka Plus

Powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 SoC, performance wise it is one of the best phones in the budget segment. The Yu Yureka Plus' new 1080p display is a good upgrade from the original Yu Yureka which offered only a 720p display. It offers improved viewing angles and better colour reproduction.

For all you shutterbugs out there, the 13MP Sony camera on this smartphone does a decent job when it comes to taking pictures but falls short of quality achieved by the Meizu M2 Note or the Asus Zenfone 2 Laser. Moreover, it comes pre-loaded with the highly popular CyanogenMod ROM. This gives the phones a very stock-Android like experience and adds a bunch of software tricks as well.

Third

Lenovo K3 Note

Lenovo's K3 Note has all the components



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to make it a very good smartphone but in falters when it is pushed beyond its comfort zone. The thing is, day to day performance is quite good but when it comes to heavy gaming, the phone runs out of steam. Nonetheless, it is still a very good phone and that is why we recommend the Lenovo K3 Note. Powered by an octa-core processor, the K3 Note is a champ in the synthetic benchmarks. The big display is great if you wish to view a lot of video.

Best Buy

Meizu M2 Note

Meizu is still a young brand but we won't hesitate to recommend it. The M2 Note is a brilliant offering from the company which offers a consistent performance across all quantifiable aspects making it the best option available in the sub-10k segment. To top it all, it is available without any registrations or flash sales. **1**